



Hope for the Common Man

OUR PROGRAMMES

What We Do, and How It Fits Together

A plain-language guide to the Foundation's three pillars and the programmes within them — what each one does, who it is for, and what it sets out to change.



Education & Skills

Educate the mind



**Livelihoods &
Economic Inclusion**

Equip the hands



**Shelter, WASH
& Protection**

Secure the home



START HERE

How Our Work Is Organised

Synia Aid Foundation works with internally displaced persons and with indigent communities across Nigeria. Everything we do sits under **three pillars** — the same three symbols you will find in our logo. Together they form one idea: **educate the mind, equip the hands, secure the home**.

 1 • Education & Skills <i>Educate the mind</i> • Learning Access & Retention (Train a Child) • Synia Scholars Fund • Youth Skills & Employability	 2 • Livelihoods & Economic Inclusion <i>Equip the hands</i> • Enterprise Development • Savings & Financial Inclusion • Women's Economic Empowerment	 3 • Shelter, WASH & Protection <i>Secure the home</i> • Safe Shelter • Water, Sanitation & Hygiene • Emergency Response & Household Recovery • Protection & Rights
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Two further programmes **run across all three pillars** rather than sitting inside any one of them: **Community Wellbeing & Mental Health**, and **Durable Solutions & Resettlement Support**. They are described on page 8.

Why three pillars, and not more

A family that has been displaced does not have one problem. The children are out of school, the adults have lost their trade, and the home is gone. Relief alone treats the symptom. Our three pillars are designed to be used together, and a household may be supported by more than one at the same time.

We have deliberately kept the structure small. It is easier to do a few things properly, and to prove that they worked, than to do many things and prove nothing.

RUNNING NOW

The programme is operating today. We report on it.

IN SET-UP

Designed and being put in place, but not yet awarding or delivering.

PLANNED

Approved in our plan and scheduled, but not yet started. We say so plainly rather than implying it is already running.

How we decide who we help

We act according to **need** — not status, ethnicity, gender, religion, politics or any other interest. Selection is made against a written scoring sheet and verified in the community. A referral alone is never a route into a programme. Within each group we give priority to displaced households, female-headed households, people with disabilities, older people living alone, and households with young children.

What we promise about how we report

We report our reach honestly and conservatively. Each programme has a small number of measures attached to it, and we distinguish between what we *did* and what actually *changed*. Where we do not yet have the data to make a claim, we do not make it.



PILLAR ONE

Education & Skills

Educate the mind

Displacement takes children out of school, often for years. Our first pillar exists to put them back in, keep them there, and carry the ones who can go further as far as they are able to go.

Learning Access & Retention Programme

Known publicly as [Train a Child](#) · Our flagship education programme

RUNNING NOW

WHAT IT DOES

We find children who are out of school and bring them back. Where a child has missed too much to simply rejoin their year group, we run a catch-up learning block first so they can be placed at the right level. We then cover school fees and levies, uniform, books and examination costs, and we follow up every term to make sure the child is actually attending.

WHO IT IS FOR

Displaced and indigent children who have never been to school, who have dropped out, or who are enrolled but at risk of leaving because of cost, distance, caring duties or menstrual health. Support for girls to stay in school — the work we have run as *Pad A Girl* — sits inside this programme.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

The child is still in school at the end of the year and moves up to the next grade. Not simply that a fee was paid.

Synia Scholars Fund

Scholarships beyond basic education

IN SET-UP

WHAT IT DOES

Funds senior secondary and tertiary study for students who have the ability but not the means. Awards are made by a selection panel against criteria we publish, and the money is held and accounted for separately from our general funds so that donors can see exactly where their gift went.

WHO IT IS FOR

Students progressing beyond basic education, including those who came to us through Train a Child. Selection is need-led first.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Scholars complete their course and qualify — not merely that they enrolled.

Youth Skills & Employability Programme

Trade skills and a route into work

PLANNED

WHAT IT DOES

Practical trade and vocational training for young people, paired with apprenticeships and real help finding work at the end of it. Training that does not lead anywhere is training wasted, so placement is part of the programme rather than an afterthought.

WHO IT IS FOR

Young people aged roughly 15 to 24, particularly those who have left school without a qualification.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

The young person is certified *and* in work.

Where education ends and livelihoods begin. If what we are measuring is **learning or a qualification**, the person is supported under Pillar 1. If what we are measuring is **income or a business**, they move to Pillar 2. It is a simple rule, and it stops the same person being counted twice in our figures.



PILLAR TWO

Livelihoods & Economic Inclusion

Equip the hands

Relief meets today's need. An income meets next year's. Our second pillar helps adults who have lost their livelihood to build one that holds — and then to stop needing us.

Enterprise Development Programme

Our flagship livelihoods programme, in three steps **RUNNING NOW**

WHAT IT DOES

Business and trade skills training, followed by a grant or a set of tools to begin trading, six months of mentoring from someone who has done it, and introductions to actual buyers. Grants are released in stages against agreed milestones rather than as a single lump sum — it protects the money, and it protects the person.

THE THREE STEPS

Start — for those with no business, or trading under six months. **Grow** — working capital, pricing and record-keeping for those already trading. **Scale** — growth capital, formal registration and buyer introductions for those employing others. A person moves up a step when they are ready, and is never in two steps at once.

WHO IT IS FOR

Displaced and indigent adults, with priority to female-headed households, relocated households and people with disabilities.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

The business is *still trading twelve months later*, and the household is earning more than when it started.

Savings & Financial Inclusion Programme

Small savings groups **PLANNED**

WHAT IT DOES

Brings people together into small savings groups where members save regularly, borrow from the shared pool, and build a cushion. It is one of the most effective and lowest-cost tools in the sector, and it keeps working long after we have gone.

WHO IT IS FOR

Anyone in our livelihoods programmes, and others in the same community who wish to join.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Members hold real savings and can absorb a shock — an illness, a bad month — without selling the tools of their trade.

Women's Economic Empowerment Programme

Targeted support for women and female-headed households **PLANNED**

WHAT IT DOES

Skills, assets, access to markets and awareness of rights, aimed specifically at women facing economic exclusion. It sits alongside a commitment that every programme we run must work for women — this one exists to go further, not to excuse the others.

WHO IT IS FOR

Women and female-headed households, including widows and women displaced with dependent children.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Women earning independently, and holding decisions about their own income.



PILLAR THREE

Shelter, WASH & Protection

Secure the home

A safe home is the floor everything else stands on. This pillar covers the roof over a family's head, the water they drink, the help they need in a crisis — and their right to stay where they have rebuilt.

Safe Shelter Programme

Our flagship shelter programme **RUNNING NOW**

WHAT IT DOES

Repairs and upgrades shelter that is leaking, unsafe or offers no privacy; builds transitional shelter where there is none; and provides household kits. Every shelter is assessed against a written safety standard before and after the work, then checked again at three and twelve months. Households contribute their own labour wherever they can — homes people helped build are homes people maintain.

WHO IT IS FOR

Displaced households in camps, host communities and resettlement sites, with priority to female-headed households, older people living alone and families with infants.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

The home meets the safety standard when we re-inspect it, and the family is still living in it a year later.

Water, Sanitation & Hygiene (WASH) Programme

Clean water and safe sanitation **PLANNED**

WHAT IT DOES

Clean water, safe toilets, handwashing facilities and hygiene education. Technical work is delivered with specialist partners, and we budget for keeping facilities working — not only for building them.

WHO IT IS FOR

Camps, resettlement sites and host communities where water and sanitation are inadequate.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Facilities still functioning a year on, and fewer preventable illnesses in the community.



PILLAR THREE • CONTINUED

Shelter, WASH & Protection

Secure the home

Emergency Response & Household Recovery Programme

Help in the first days, and the months after **PLANNED**

WHAT IT DOES

Essential household items straight after a crisis and — where markets are working — cash or vouchers, so families buy what they most need rather than what we guessed they need. Support then continues through recovery.

WHO IT IS FOR

Newly displaced or relocated households, and families recovering from conflict, flood or fire.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

The household meets its basic needs without having to sell what it will need to recover.

Protection & Rights Programme

Legal help, documents, and the right to remain **PLANNED**

WHAT IT DOES

Displaced people often lose their papers along with their homes — and without papers they cannot enrol a child, claim what they are owed or prove where they live. We provide legal advice, help recovering identity and civil documents, advice on housing and land rights so families are not evicted from homes they rebuilt, and referral to specialist services.

WHO IT IS FOR

Displaced households whose right to remain, or whose legal identity, is uncertain or contested.

WHY IT MATTERS TO US

The Foundation grew out of legal research on the protection of displaced people. It is why we check a family's right to remain *before* investing in their shelter.



Running Through Everything

Two programmes are not confined to a single pillar. They support all three, and they are how we meet people before a programme begins and stay with them after it ends.

Community Wellbeing & Mental Health

Known publicly as [MindCheck](#) **PLANNED — FORMALISING WORK ALREADY UNDER WAY**

WHAT IT DOES

Health and medical outreaches, mental-health awareness and counselling, community road walks, and the MindCheck platform — a free and confidential way for someone to check how they are doing and reach help early, without stigma. This is some of the longest-running work we do, and we are now giving it its own budget, its own measures and a named person accountable for it.

WHO IT IS FOR

Whole communities, not only the households enrolled in our other programmes.

WHY IT SITS ACROSS EVERYTHING

It is how we build trust in a community before a programme starts, and how we keep dignity and wellbeing at the centre of education, livelihoods and shelter alike.

Durable Solutions & Resettlement Support

Support for households being resettled **PLANNED**

WHAT IT DOES

Many displaced families in and around the Federal Capital Territory are being relocated to resettlement sites, including in Nasarawa and Keffi. Moving is not the end of displacement; it is the beginning of settling. This programme accompanies households through that move — shelter, schooling, documentation, and a livelihood in the new place.

WHO IT IS FOR

Households being relocated, and the communities receiving them.

WHY WE ARE PLACED TO DO IT

We already work along this corridor. It is an area of real need that comparatively few organisations cover.

ONE MORE THING THAT RUNS THROUGH EVERYTHING

Safeguarding. Every person delivering our work is vetted and bound by a code of conduct, no child is ever met alone, and a plain-language route to raise a concern is displayed wherever we work. A programme does not begin until that is in place. It is not a section of our plan; it is a condition of operating.



ON ONE PAGE

The Whole Structure

PILLAR	PROGRAMME	STATUS	IN ONE LINE
1 • Education & Skills Educate the mind	Learning Access & Retention Train a Child	RUNNING NOW	Gets out-of-school children back into school, and keeps them there
	Synia Scholars Fund	IN SET-UP	Scholarships for senior secondary and tertiary study
	Youth Skills & Employability	PLANNED	Trade skills and apprenticeships that end in a real job
2 • Livelihoods & Economic Inclusion Equip the hands	Enterprise Development Start • Grow • Scale	RUNNING NOW	Skills, staged capital and mentoring to build a business that lasts
	Savings & Financial Inclusion	PLANNED	Small savings groups that keep working after we leave
	Women's Economic Empowerment	PLANNED	Targeted economic support for women and female-headed households
3 • Shelter, WASH & Protection Secure the home	Safe Shelter	RUNNING NOW	Repairs, upgrades and builds homes to a written safety standard
	Water, Sanitation & Hygiene	PLANNED	Clean water, safe toilets and hygiene, built to keep working
	Emergency Response & Household Recovery	PLANNED	Essential items, cash or vouchers, and support through recovery
	Protection & Rights	PLANNED	Legal help, documents, and the right to stay in a rebuilt home
Across all three Cross-cutting	Community Wellbeing & Mental Health MindCheck	PLANNED	Health and mental-health outreach, and early access to support
	Durable Solutions & Resettlement Support	PLANNED	Accompanies households through relocation and settling

Why we show you what is not yet running.

It would be easy to print all twelve programmes and let a reader assume they are all operating. We would rather tell you plainly which three are running today, which is being set up, and which are scheduled. An organisation that describes its plans as its achievements cannot be trusted with the achievements either.

How the three pillars work together

Take one family. The Safe Shelter Programme makes the home weatherproof and secure, and the Protection & Rights Programme confirms they cannot be moved off the land. With the home settled, Train a Child gets the two younger children back into school, and the eldest applies to the Synia Scholars Fund. The mother joins the Enterprise Development Programme and a savings group. Eighteen months later the family is housed, the children are learning, and the household has an income.

That is what we mean by *educate the mind*, *equip the hands*, *secure the home*. Not three services, but one road out.

Every contribution — of money, time or expertise — powers real education, empowerment and relief. There are four ways to stand with the Foundation.

- 01 Donate** — fund a child's school year, a household's shelter repair, or a trader's start in business. One-off or recurring gifts, from ₦5,000 upward.
- 02 Partner** — bring your organisation's resources, reach or technical expertise to a shared programme. Partnership is how we multiply what we can do; almost every project on our record was delivered alongside someone else.
- 03 Volunteer** — give your time and skills on our outreaches and in your own community.
- 04 Become an ambassador** — champion the Foundation's work and carry it beyond borders.

If you are considering funding us

Each programme in this guide has a written model behind it — who it serves, what the standard package contains, what it costs per person, how it is measured, and when support ends. We are glad to share the relevant model, and to talk honestly about what we can and cannot yet evidence.

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About this guide. It sets out the Foundation's programme structure as at July 2026 and will be reissued as programmes move from planned to running. Nothing described here as planned should be taken as currently operating.



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